

MAKE YOUR OWN HERO!

CHARACTER CREATION GUIDE



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For players ages 9–12 · Dungeons & Dragons 5th Edition

You just finished an adventure with pre-made heroes. Now it is **your turn** to invent someone totally new — your name, your look, your personality, your powers. Work through this booklet **one step at a time**, then give your sheet to the DM so they can check the numbers.

You will also get: the **Basic Rules** booklet, a **Species Handbook**, a **Class Handbook**, and (if your class uses magic or gear lists) a **Spell Book** or **Gear Book**.

BEFORE YOU START: THREE BIG IDEAS



1. **Your character is a team player.** You are brave, funny, or clever — but you care about your friends.
2. **Failure is fun.** If you roll low, something silly or exciting usually happens. That is part of the game!
3. **There are no wrong ideas.** A pastry knight, a nervous filing clerk, and a bronze golem can all be heroes. Pick what makes you excited.

THE 10 STEPS (CHECK THEM OFF!)

STEP	WHAT YOU DO
☐ 1	Dream up your hero (concept)
☐ 2	Pick your species (who you are)
☐ 3	Pick your class (what you do)
☐ 4	Assign your ability scores (your stats)
☐ 5	Write down modifiers and saving throws
☐ 6	Choose skills you are good at
☐ 7	Pick armor, weapons, and gear
☐ 8	Calculate AC, HP, speed, and attacks
☐ 9	Pick spells (if you cast magic)
☐ 10	Add personality, background, and a quirk

STEP 1 — DREAM UP YOUR HERO

Answer these questions in your own words. There are no wrong answers!

QUESTION	YOUR ANSWER
What is your hero's name?	
What do they look like? (height, colors, clothing, anything weird)	
What is one word that describes their personality? (brave, silly, grumpy, curious...)	
What do they want? (save a village, find treasure, prove themselves, eat the world's best sandwich...)	
What are they afraid of? (spiders, being embarrassed, loud noises...)	
What is their signature thing? (a catchphrase, a lucky hat, always humming, collects buttons...)	

Tip: Steal ideas from books, games, or your pre-made hero — but change enough that this one feels like *yours*.

STEP 2 — PICK YOUR SPECIES

Your **species** (also called race) is *what kind of creature you are*. It gives you special traits and helps you imagine how you look.

Open your **Species Handbook** and read the one you like. Then write it here:

MY SPECIES:

SPECIES YOU CAN CHOOSE FROM

SPECIES	IN ONE SENTENCE
Human	Brave and good at a little bit of everything.
Elf	Graceful, magical, pointy ears, see well in the dark.
Dwarf	Tough, sturdy, loves mountains and metalwork.
Halfling	Small, lucky, very sneaky.
Dragonborn	Dragon-person who can breathe fire, ice, or lightning.
Gnome	Small, clever, full of ideas and tinkering.
Tiefling	Horned and tail; connected to strange magic.
Orc	Strong, fierce, hard to knock down.
Goliath	Very tall and very strong.
Aasimar	Glow with holy or mysterious energy.
Tabaxi	Cat-person who is super fast, sneaky, and curious.

Copy any special traits from your Species Handbook onto your character sheet (darkvision, extra speed, breath weapon, etc.).

STEP 3 — PICK YOUR CLASS

Your **class** is your **job on the adventure team**. It tells you what you are best at in fights and out of fights.

Open your **Class Handbook** and pick one. Write it here:

MY CLASS:

CLASS QUICK GUIDE — WHICH SOUNDS LIKE YOU?

CLASS	YOU MIGHT LIKE THIS IF...
Fighter	You want to hit hard with swords, axes, or bows.
Barbarian	You want to get angry and smash things.
Rogue	You want to sneak, pick locks, and surprise enemies.
Wizard	You want lots of spells and big brain energy.
Sorcerer	Magic runs in your blood — you cast from instinct.
Cleric	You heal friends and smite bad guys with holy power.
Paladin	You are a holy knight with armor and honor.
Ranger	You love nature, tracking, and fighting at range.
Druid	You talk to animals and control plants and weather.
Bard	You sing, joke, and help the team with charm and magic.
Monk	You fight fast with fists and fancy footwork.
Warlock	You made a deal with a mysterious power for magic.

Ask the DM: Some classes use **spell slots** (magic batteries). Some use **Ki** or **Channel Divinity**. Your Class Handbook explains yours.

STEP 4 — ASSIGN YOUR ABILITY SCORES

Every hero has **six ability scores**. They measure how good you are at different things.

ABILITY	WHAT IT MEANS	GOOD FOR...
Strength (STR)	Muscle	Big weapons, breaking doors, climbing
Dexterity (DEX)	Speed & reflexes	Bows, sneaking, dodging
Constitution (CON)	Toughness	Hit points, surviving poison
Intelligence (INT)	Book smarts	Wizards, investigation, history
Wisdom (WIS)	Instinct & awareness	Clerics, druids, noticing traps
Charisma (CHA)	Charm & leadership	Bards, paladins, talking to NPCs

HOW TO GET YOUR SIX NUMBERS

Your DM will give you one of these methods:

Method A — The Fair Six (Standard Array) You get these six numbers: **15, 14, 13, 12, 10, 8** Assign each number to one ability. Put the **big numbers** on abilities your class uses most!

Method B — Roll for Drama Roll **4d6** (four six-sided dice), drop the lowest die, add the rest. Do this **six times**. Ask the DM to help if any number seems too low — they may let you reroll ones.

Method C — The DM Helps Describe your hero and the DM suggests scores that fit.

WHERE TO PUT YOUR NUMBERS (CHEAT SHEET)

CLASS	PUT YOUR BEST SCORES IN...
Fighter, Barbarian, Paladin	STR, CON
Rogue, Ranger, Monk	DEX, then WIS or STR
Wizard	INT, CON
Sorcerer, Warlock, Bard	CHA, CON
Cleric, Druid	WIS, CON

Species bonus: Some species add +2 or +1 to certain abilities. Add those *after* you assign numbers. Check your Species Handbook!

Write your final scores here:

ABILITY	SCORE (AFTER SPECIES BONUSES)
STR	
DEX	
CON	
INT	
WIS	
CHA	

STEP 5 — MODIFIERS AND SAVING THROWS

FIND YOUR MODIFIER

Look up each score on this table. You will add the **modifier** to almost every roll.

SCORE	MODIFIER	SCORE	MODIFIER
8–9	–1	14–15	+2
10–11	+0	16–17	+3
12–13	+1	18–19	+4

Write your modifiers:

ABILITY	SCORE	MODIFIER
STR		
DEX		
CON		
INT		
WIS		
CHA		

PROFICIENCY BONUS

Your DM tells you your **level**. At **level 1**, your proficiency bonus is **+2**. At **level 5**, it is **+3**.

PROFICIENCY BONUS: _____

You are **proficient** in some saving throws because of your class. For those, add **modifier + proficiency bonus**.

Example: A level 5 Cleric with WIS 16 (+3) has **WIS save +6** (+3 mod + +3 proficiency).

Copy saving throws from your Class Handbook:

SAVE	ROLL D20 +
STR	
DEX	
CON	
INT	
WIS	
CHA	

STEP 6 — CHOOSE YOUR SKILLS

Skills are specific things you are trained in – like Stealth, Athletics, or Persuasion.

- Your **class** gives you a list of skills to pick from.
- Your **background** (Step 10) may give you two more.
- When you are **proficient** in a skill, add your **proficiency bonus** to the roll.

HOW A SKILL ROLL WORKS

Skill roll = d20 + ability modifier + proficiency bonus (if proficient)

Skill	Uses This Ability
Athletics	STR
Acrobatics, Sleight of Hand, Stealth	DEX
Arcana, History, Investigation, Nature, Religion	INT
Animal Handling, Insight, Medicine, Perception, Survival	WIS
Deception, Intimidation, Performance, Persuasion	CHA

My proficient skills: (list them and write the total bonus)

STEP 7 — ARMOR, WEAPONS, AND GEAR

Your **Class Handbook** lists starting equipment. Your DM may let you swap similar items.

ARMOR QUICK REFERENCE

ARMOR	AC IT GIVES	WHO USUALLY WEARS IT
No armor	10 + DEX mod	Wizards in robes
Leather / studded leather	11-12 + DEX mod	Rogues, rangers
Chain mail	16 (no DEX bonus)	Fighters, paladins
Plate	18 (no DEX bonus)	Heavy knights, clerics

Shield: +2 AC if you carry one (and your class allows it).

WEAPONS QUICK REFERENCE

WEAPON TYPE	EXAMPLE	DAMAGE DIE	USES
Light & fast	Dagger, shortsword	1d4-1d6	DEX or STR
Medium	Longsword, warhammer	1d8	Usually STR
Big & heavy	Greatsword, maul	2d6	STR
Ranged	Shortbow, crossbow	1d6-1d8	DEX

MY ARMOR:

My shield? ☐ Yes ☐ No

MY MAIN WEAPON:

MY BACKUP / RANGED WEAPON:

Other gear: (rope, torches, rations, tools — list from class)

STEP 8 — AC, HP, SPEED, AND ATTACKS

ARMOR CLASS (AC)

AC = how hard you are to hit. Enemies must roll **your AC or higher** on a d20 to hurt you.

Ask the DM or use your Class Handbook to calculate AC. Write it big:

MY AC:

HIT POINTS (HP)

HP = your health. At **0 HP**, you fall unconscious (but your friends can still save you!).

At level 1: HP = **hit die maximum** + CON modifier (Example: Fighter d10 → 10 + CON mod)

Each level after: Add **hit die roll** (or average) + CON modifier each time you level up. Your DM helps at the table.

MY HP: current / max

MY HIT DIE: d _____ (e.g. d8 for a rogue)

MY SPEED: _____ ft. (usually 30; some species are faster or slower)

ATTACKS

To hit: d20 + ability modifier + proficiency bonus (if proficient with that weapon)

Damage: weapon damage die + ability modifier (usually STR for melee, DEX for finesse/ranged)

Fill in your main attack:

ATTACK	TO HIT (D20 +)	DAMAGE
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Initiative (who goes first in combat): $d20 + \text{DEX modifier} = d20 +$

STEP 9 — SPELLS (MAGIC USERS ONLY)

Skip this step if your class does **not** cast spells (Fighter, Barbarian, Rogue without magic, etc.).

TWO KINDS OF MAGIC

KIND	WHAT IT MEANS
Cantrips	Small spells you can cast all day long — no slot needed!
Leveled spells	Big spells that use a spell slot (1st level, 2nd level, etc.)

When you run out of spell slots, you need a **long rest** (8 hours of sleep) to get them back.

SPELLCASTING NUMBERS (FROM CLASS HANDBOOK)

Spell save DC = 8 + proficiency + spellcasting ability modifier
Spell attack = d20 + proficiency + spellcasting ability modifier

MY SPELLCASTING ABILITY	
Spell save DC	
Spell attack (d20 +)	

Cantrips I know: 1. 2.

Leveled spells I know: (check your handbook for how many you can pick)

LEVEL	SPELLS	SPELL SLOTS
1st		/
2nd		/
3rd		/

Use your **Spell Book** or **Spell Cards** during play so you do not have to memorize everything!

STEP 10 — PERSONALITY, BACKGROUND, AND QUIRK

This is the **most important step** for making your hero feel real.

BACKGROUND

Pick or invent a **background** — what your hero did before adventuring.

BACKGROUND IDEA	YOU WERE...
Folk Hero	A village favorite who did something brave
Scholar	A student, librarian, or inventor
Soldier	A guard, knight-in-training, or soldier
Urchin	Grew up on the streets, quick and scrappy
Acolyte	Served at a temple or shrine
Entertainer	Actor, musician, or circus performer
Custom	Invent your own! (Ask the DM)

MY BACKGROUND:

ONE SKILL OR TOOL IT GIVES ME:

PERSONALITY (FILL IN AT LEAST THREE)

PROMPT	YOUR ANSWER
I always...	
I never...	
I love...	
I hate...	
My friends would say I am...	

QUIRK (OPTIONAL BUT FUN!)

Every hero in our last adventure had a **quirk** — a small special rule that made them unique. Work with your DM to invent one!

Examples:

- Smell like fresh cookies (enemies have trouble intimidating you)
- Pull random useful junk from your pockets
- Must narrate everything as an accident
- Spark slightly when nervous (advantage on metal-related checks once per day)
- Cannot tell a lie but somehow still succeeds at deception

MY QUIRK:

FINAL CHECKLIST — GIVE THIS TO YOUR DM

Before your first session with your new hero, make sure you have:

☐	ITEM
☐	Name, species, class, and level
☐	All six ability scores and modifiers
☐	AC, HP, speed, initiative
☐	Attacks (to hit and damage)
☐	Saving throws and proficient skills
☐	Spells and spell slots (if any)
☐	Equipment list
☐	Personality, background, and quirk
☐	My Hero Character Sheet filled in (ask your DM for the booklet!)
☐	Species Handbook + Class Handbook tucked in your folder

Well done, adventurer. Your hero is ready for the next quest!

Copy everything onto your **My Hero Character Sheet** — your DM has a separate booklet for that.

Dungeon Master: pair this guide with Kids_DnD_Basic_Rules, the species handbooks in species/, the class handbooks in classes/, and Kids_DnD_Character_Sheet for fill-in sheets.